

Space age

We take a look at the problems of farming in space for space faring humans, our possible progeny.

FBI's Facial Recognition

Fingerprinting has been a staple for the FBI, but now they've moved on to facial recognition <http://dgit.in/FBIFacialRecog>

The Return of the

The PC isn't dead! Like a phoenix rising from the ashes we take a look at the next revolution of personal computing technologies.

PC Master Race

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Not a year goes by without someone making the declaration that "The PC is dead!" The 2014 Consumer Electronics Show hosted last January was no different. With the wide assortment of post-PC gadgets being touted for days—the show was overtaken by products and services such as tablets, phablets, wearable tech, game controllers and 4K curved TVs, with brand name releases such as new Chromebooks, Valve's Steam Machines, Sony's Playstation Now service, Razer's Project Christine and the Oculus Rift. It was clear that the PC market had defragmented beyond repair—with appliance-based devices being the next generation of personal computing—where computing wasn't really the point.

But as with all things in technology—change happens quickly. And although the broad truths of the post-PC world hold true—with fewer users looking to a singular computing device for all their varied needs—it's still too early to pull the plug on where personal computing is headed. The signs of the PC's resurgence lies in the unspoken, unrecognised and almost creepy proclivities towards innovation. So although it's easier to look at the change and call it death, we know that it's nothing but the chrysalis from which something new and extraordinary is sure to emerge.

Innovation Is Where It's At

The PC is a mysterious mistress, constantly changing its form, keeping us



Innovation in PC design such as Razer's Project Christine for modular design are on the cutting edge.

unsure of its true nature. While companies like Apple are determined to restrict the personal computer within the realm of the appliance—like a toaster or washing machine—the true technology culturalist recognises the PC platform as one of innovation. And while it must be acknowledged that it was the Apple Macintosh that gave the world beautiful typeface fonts on its screens, it was the PC wave that allowed casual users to learn how to make their own fonts. The Glorious PC Master Race is one built on adaptability, upgradability and flexibility, and it's they who recognise that the difference between "a tool to employ" and "an instrument to wield" is a subtle one. This is where PC's still find relevance.

It's an obvious fact that with the recent trends in extreme, personalised computing and the emergence of wearable,

cloud supported tech, that PCs will find new form factors. But the core body of its desktop avatar isn't one that will vanish into disparate devices, rather, it'll be enhanced with newer forms.

Eight Things To Rule Them All

But even as we go on proselytising and evangelizing the glories of all things PC, this isn't a religious pulpit we speak from, but a rational one. Once we consider the next wave of revolutionary technologies nearing their release for PC systems there will surely be very little convincing required on their part.

AMD's 25x Energy Efficiency Boost:

Ambitions are sky high in computer processing and even as we recover from the reeling developments in quantum and neuromorphic processors (IBM's TrueNorth chip) we find AMD planning a release for their most promising chip yet. Being called the "24X20" target, AMD has started plans to develop a radically new generation Accelerated Processing Unit (APUs) with 25 times the energy efficiency by 2020. This is a huge leap considering that the last six years have only seen a ten times increase in efficiency. This development means that with the expected exponential expanse of personal computing on the horizon, users will be able to save massively on their energy costs—which amounts to nearly USD 20 billion of savings annually across the world.

By employing a combination of innovative techniques such as intelligent power management systems, advanced APU architectural designs, improved semiconductor manufacturing processes and